TWO TO TANGO
Architects Sonali Bhagwati and Sohrab Dalal in their apartment in a Gurgaon high-rise (left); textures meet pattern in this bedroom for a client in Gurgaon by DPA (below)



when I came back, my best friend, Mohit Gujral, who was also from CEPT, his father had just started doing some architecture. So, I worked with Satish Gujral for about a year. And by that time, Sonali had completed her thesis. Then we decided to—along with another colleague from Ahmedabad—start a small firm. It was originally called Atelier, but then it was converted to Spazio," explains Dalal.

Then the three of them started their practice in 1985, in a garage at his home in Vasant Vihar. They had only three desks because the garage couldn't fit in anymore. "I think if the temperature was 42 outside, it was 43 inside because there was no fan. We just had one pedestal fan," he adds. Then the practice grew, so they moved to Greater Kailash, where Bhagwati had an apartment. "Initially, we were doing smaller residential projects, anything really that came our way," says Dalal. This slowly paved way for bigger projects both in the residential and commercial sector. Then in 2010 with just Bhagwati and Dalal at the helm, they set up DPA.

While Dalal and his team look at the architecture related work, Bhagwati's team takes care of interior design. "Currently, we are working on two huge mixed-use projects for INKA, which is the parent company of Ikea. Mixed-use means it's not just a mall, there will be two or three dif-